

Who Can Turn Off Your Ethereum App?

A Full-Stack Walk-Away Test

James Carnley

Ethereum File System



Building Cypherpunk Apps

Why make an app you can walk away from?

What happens when an app disappears?

- Users lose their work and trust
- Other developers can’t rely on that functionality
- Communities splinter

Software worth building on

For people

Keep years of useful work

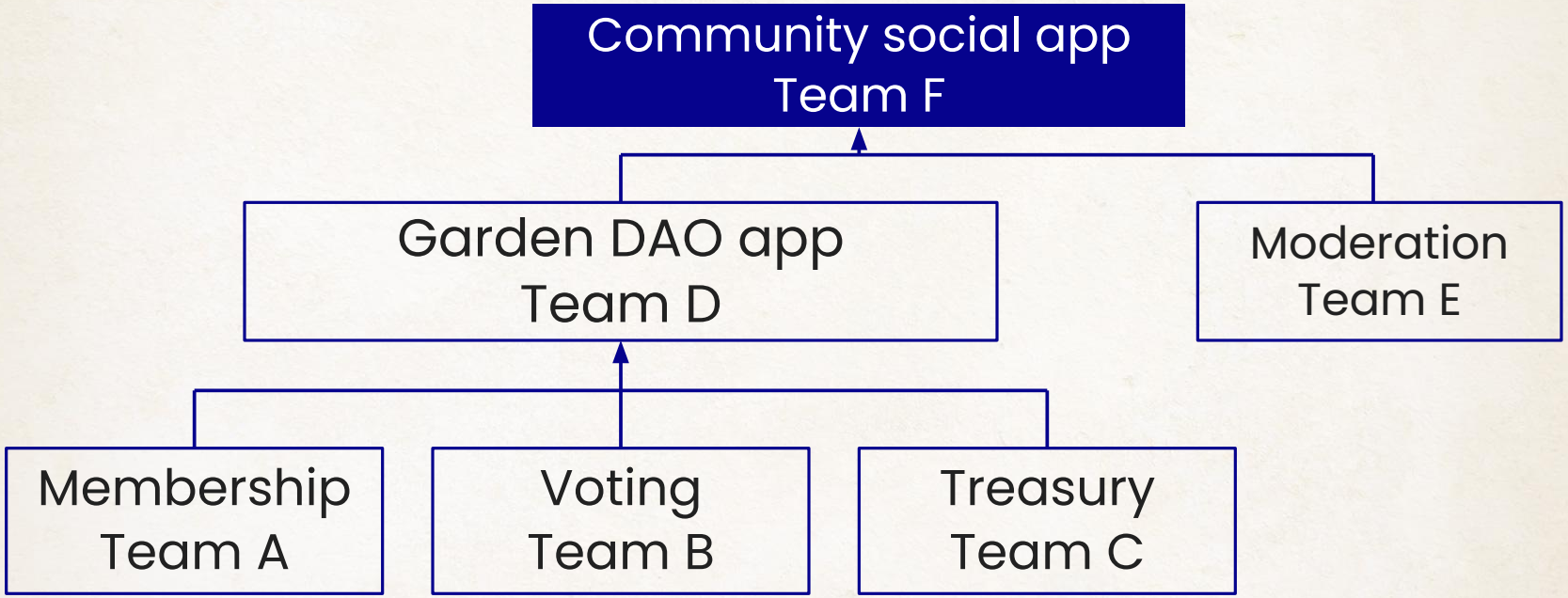
Choose better tools

For builders

Reuse dependable capabilities

Build bigger things together

Hyperstructures: build on each other



Illustrative architecture: each team adds a dependable capability

A walk-away test

The team disappears

Can users keep working?

Can others run the services?

Control becomes hostile

Can users keep their work?

Can they keep the rules they chose?

The application stack

Interface

- Names and discovery
- Runnable software
- Accounts and recovery

Data

- Storage and formats
- State and indexes
- Background work

Rules

- Contracts and governance
- Network and settlement



Interface

Finding and using the app

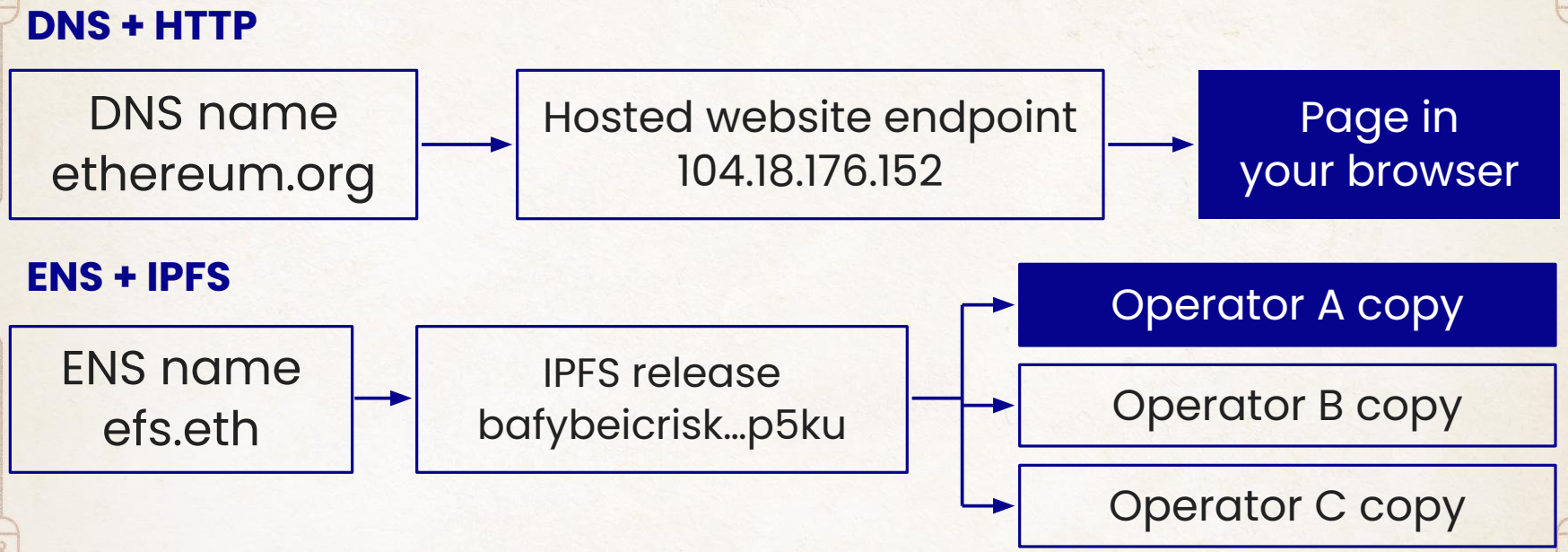
Find a saved release

Run it without your servers

Recover access without your help

Can people find and use your app?

More than one way into the app



IPFS gateways: efs.eth.limo (or .link) or your own IPFS node

A release others can run

What if the page opens but its scripts are gone?

Runnable release
HTML + JavaScript
Styles + images
Config + loaded code

↓

Maya opens the app

Build materials
Source code
Locked dependencies
Build instructions

↓

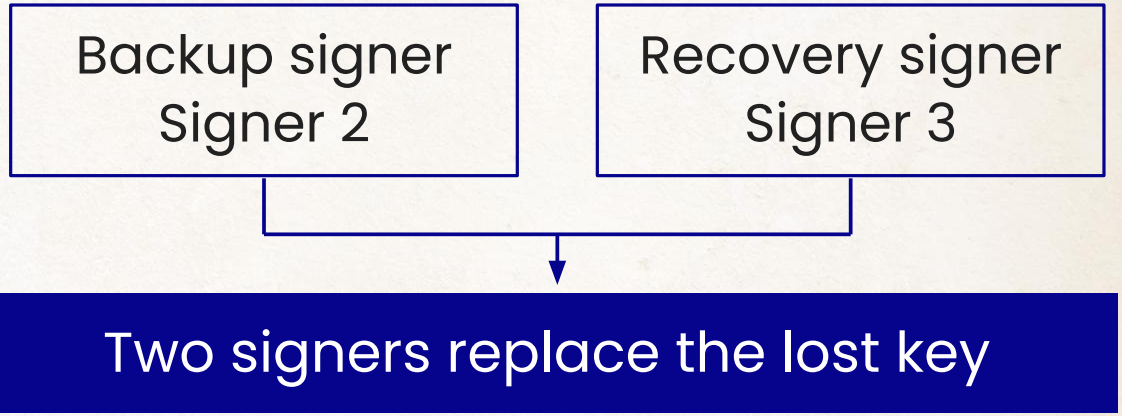
A developer rebuilds it

Check both paths on a fresh machine

Access people can recover

Safe example: two of three signers

Lost phone
Signer 1 offline



Same account
Same membership

Practice lost-device recovery. Back up private-file keys too.



Data

Continuing the work

Is the data portable?

Keep the files and their meaning

Use them through another app

Let others run the supporting services

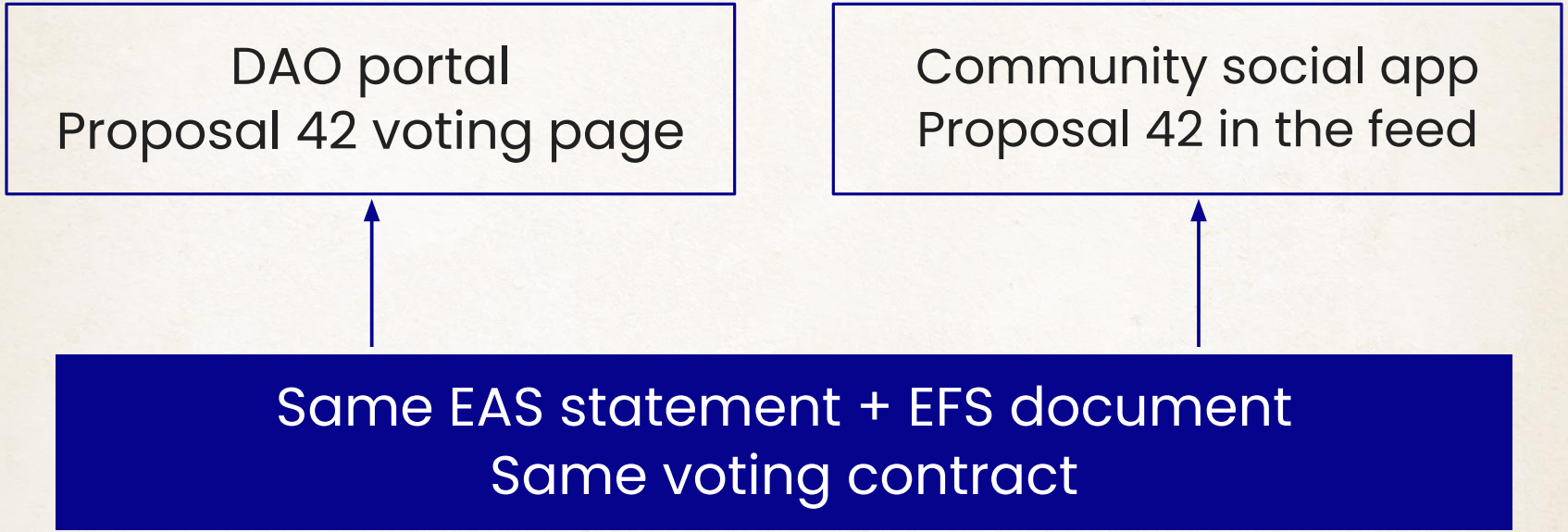
A record both apps understand

Garden DAO • Proposal 42: Fund the garden

EAS statement	EFS document
proposalId: 42 title: Fund the garden documentRef: EFS revision voteRef: chain + contract + #42	/garden/proposals/42.md Format: Markdown Metadata + file references

Illustrative records: publish the fields, meanings and reference format

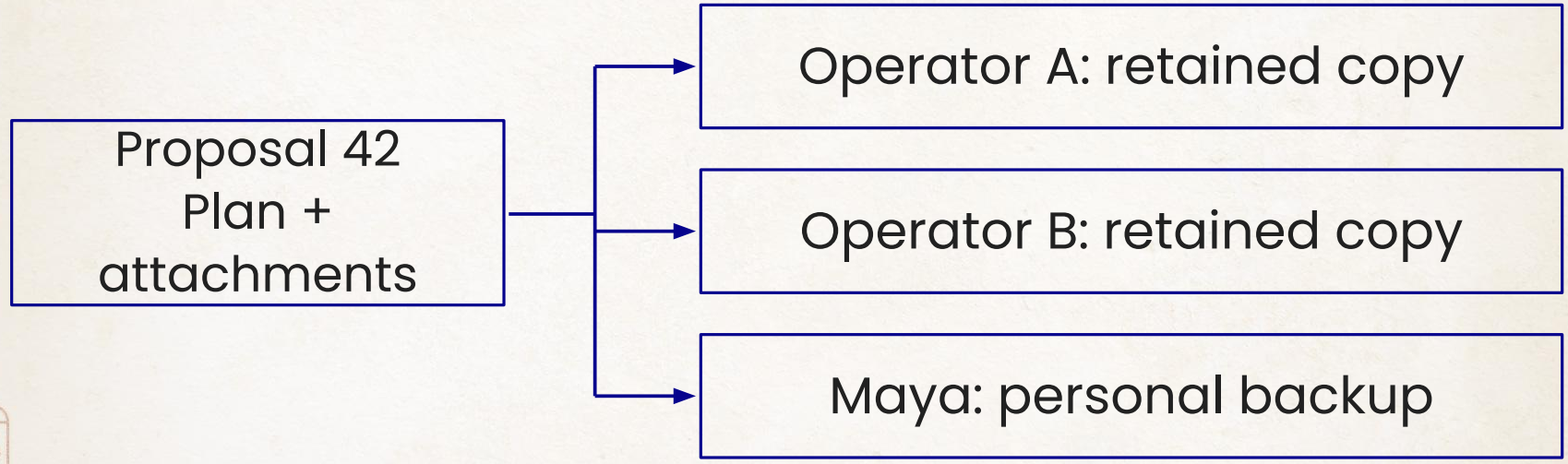
Two apps, the same proposal



Illustrative design: change the interface and keep participating

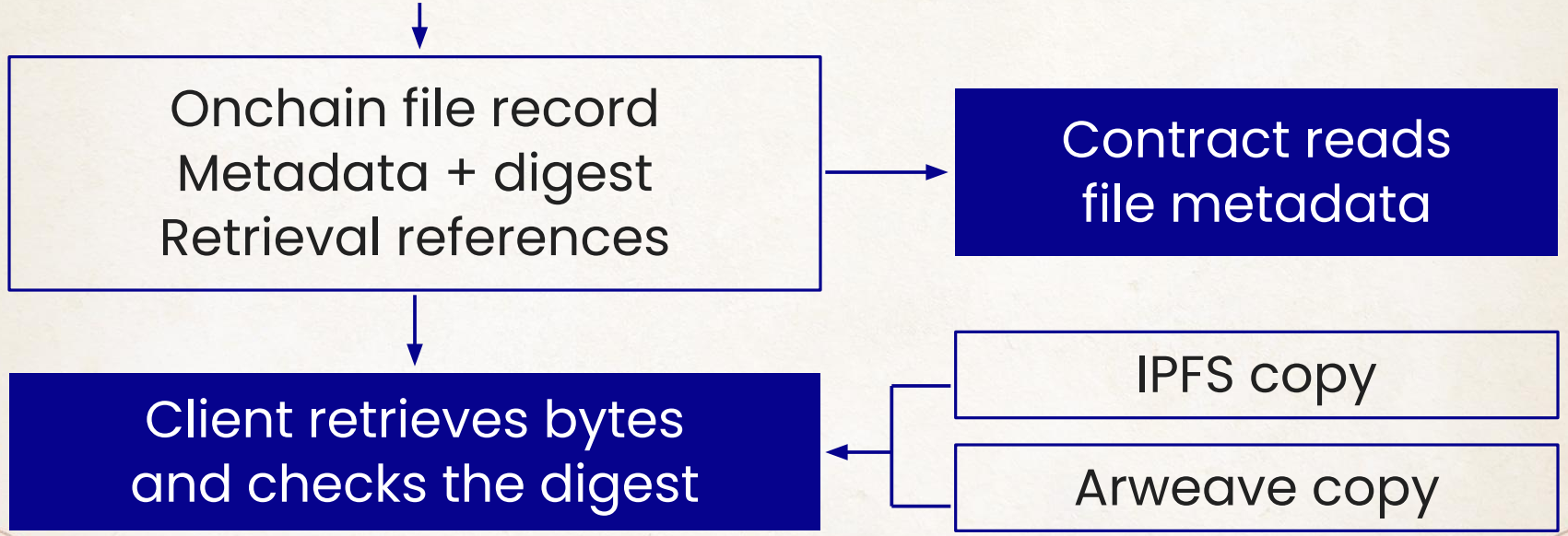
Data people can keep using

Proposal survives. Its only attachment copy disappears.



Restore the plan from another copy and open it in a compatible reader

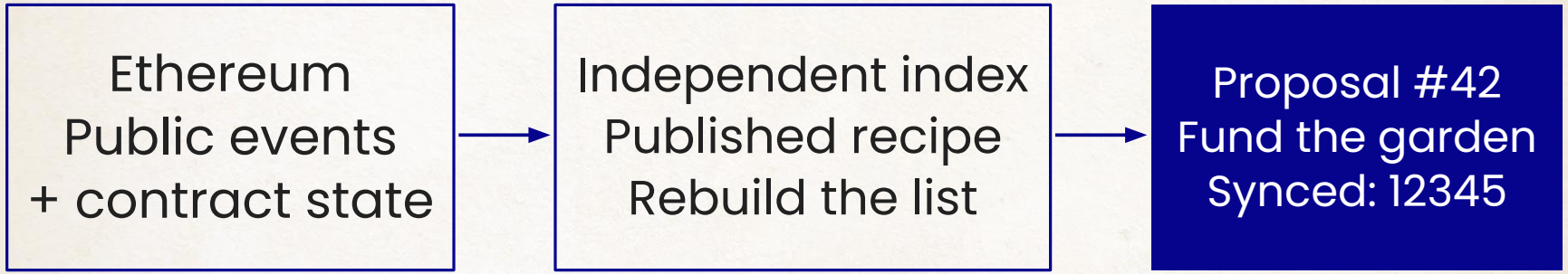
EFS: find a file and check a copy



Illustrative path: a shared reference connects apps to matching data

A dependable view of the data

The records exist. Can Maya find proposal 42?



Choose another RPC, node or replacement index

Illustrative view: rebuild discovery and show how current it is

Who sends the next transaction?

A proposal passes. Someone still has to execute it.

Team bot
Offline

Same rules. Another operator.



Illustrative drill: stop your bot and have another operator finish the job



Rules

Keeping dependable rules

Stable core contracts

User-chosen app upgrades

Clear rules for shared governance

Who chooses the changes?

Immutable contracts

A stable core

Keep the contract code fixed

Let other apps build on it

Room to improve

Deploy a new version

Let users choose to migrate

Example: Uniswap v2 core

The network beneath the app

Ethereum and L1

Keep a working node route

Retain the history you need

Understand inclusion and finality

L2 and settlement

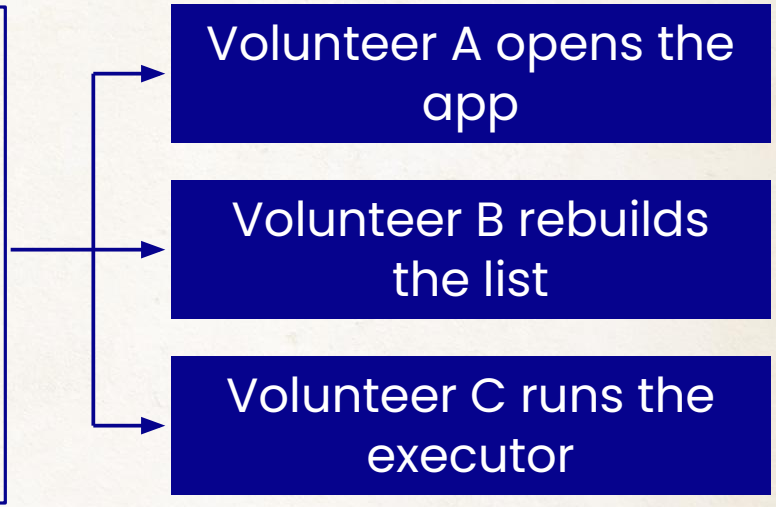
Know who orders and proves

Find the required chain data

Practice the recovery route

A community can carry it forward

Public handoff
Release + contract addresses
Retained files + index recipe
Executor + running costs



Illustrative handoff: let people outside your team follow the instructions



Putting this into practice

A walk-away test for your app

Your walk-away checklist

A user can:

Run a saved app release

Recover access and keys

Restore usable data

Choose another client

Another operator can:

Switch RPCs; rebuild views

Run workers; keep copies

Inspect admin powers

Use network recovery

Try it without your team. Improve one dependency.

Garden DAO's practice run

Find proposal 42, read its plan and cast a test vote

1. Open	2. Find	3. Repair
Saved release opens	List missing: private index	Rebuild + select replacement index

Continue: plan matches its digest → test vote gets a receipt

Next improvement: ship the index recipe and switching instructions

Illustrative drill with the original team services switched off

Our work can outlive us


Thank you!
Let’s build reliable and long-lasting apps together
James Carnley
Ethereum File System
efs.eth.limo
JamesCarnley@gmail.com
@JamesCarnley